

Zohran Mamdani: The Mayor Of NYC

[B2]

Giovane, musulmano e con un passato da rapper: scopriamo chi è il nuovo sindaco di New York, acceso oppositore della politica di Donald Trump.



Zohran Kwame Mamdani, the new mayor of New York City, is a living example of the American dream. Born in Uganda to Indian parents, the family lived in South Africa for three years before moving to New York City when Zohran was seven. On 1 January 2026 he will not only become the mayor of [arguably](#) the most iconic and globally significant city in the world but, at the age of thirty-five, he will be its youngest mayor since 1889. He will also be the first Muslim and first African-born American to [hold the post](#).

FAMILY TIES

Mamdani's mother, Mira Nair, is an [Academy Award-nominated](#) film director. His father, Mahmood, is a college professor and author who moved to the Ugandan capital Kampala with his family as a child, as part of the Indian diaspora in East Africa. Mamdani attended Bowdoin College in Brunswick, Maine, where he majored in Africana studies and minored in government. Becoming a US citizen in 2016 at the age of twenty-seven, he initially [sought a career](#) in music, releasing rap songs under the name Mr. Cardamom.

TOO PROGRESSIVE

In October 2024, after serving as a member of the New York State Assembly for nearly four years, Mamdani announced he would be [running for mayor](#) of the city. His political views, which he described as “democratic socialist,” were decidedly progressive and even scared members of his own party. While some centrist figures [distanced](#) themselves, Democrats like Bernie Sanders and Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez [endorsed](#) him publicly and campaigned with him. In June 2025, he won the Democratic primary against [former](#) New York governor Andrew Cuomo. Cuomo re-entered the race as an independent with the endorsement of Donald Trump, but lost again to Mamdani in November by a significant margin of almost 9 per cent of the total [ballots cast](#).

THE PEOPLE'S CHOICE

Mamadani has an [approachable manner](#) that has [appealed to](#) voters of all [backgrounds](#). In his campaign, he [came across](#) as empowered, [knowledgeable](#) and [personable](#). While Mamdani was campaigning, he regularly met with ordinary New Yorkers and his discourse spoke to young voters who came out in large numbers to volunteer and vote for him. So-called ‘aunties’ (a name given to older immigrant women) also campaigned for him. Mamdani's message of a more [affordable](#) city for everyone [resonated with](#) multiple generations living in one of the world's most expensive cities. He promised to make life in New York City easier by raising the taxes of big corporations and increasing the [minimum wage](#). He also [pledged](#) to reform public safety and expand [affordable](#) public

services like free buses and childcare, as well as city-operated, low-cost [grocery stores](#).

A SOCIALIST!

Mamdani's self-identification as a democratic socialist sounded all types of historic alarms in the US political establishment. President Donald Trump called him a "communist," a "[nut job](#)," and a "disaster waiting to happen." Trump has also threatened to [withhold](#) federal funding for New York City if Mamdani were elected. Even Mamdani's own party seems worried as his election [widened the gap](#) between moderate and progressive Democrats.

JUSTICE FOR PALESTINE

Mamdani's pro-Palestine [stance](#) has [rattled](#) some New Yorkers. When he was a college student, he founded a chapter of Students for Justice in Palestine, and has been critical of the actions of the Israeli government, accusing the Israel Defence Forces of committing genocide. However, when campaigning, he repeatedly denounced anti-semitism and met with many Jewish leaders.

UNCERTAIN FUTURE

While many are optimistic about Mamdani's success, he has made some big promises that will be difficult to put into action. His election as the next mayor of New York has instilled hope in the [beleaguered](#) Democratic Party. Some Democrats view the mayor-elect as a reminder that they should return to a more [grassroots](#) style of politics that brings nationalities and generations together just as Mamdani has done.

Glossary

- **hold the post** = ricoprire la carica
- **Academy Award-nominated** = candidata all'Oscar
- **sought a career** = cercare una carriera professionale
- **appealed to** = affascinare, attrarre
- **affordable** = accessibile
- **resonated with** = essere in sintonia con
- **nut job** = pazzo, svitato
- **stance** = posizione
- **endorsed** = sostenere, appoggiare
- **ballots cast** = voti espressi
- **came across** = sembrare, dare l'impressione
- **knowledgeable** = colto
- **minimum wage** = salario minimo
- **grocery stores** = negozi di alimentari
- **withhold** = ritirare
- **widened the gap** = ampliare la distanza
- **running for mayor** = candidarsi a sindaco
- **former** = ex, già
- **personable** = affabile, simpatico
- **pledged** = impegnarsi a
- **grassroots** = popolare
- **arguably** = probabilmente
- **approachable manner** = atteggiamento alla mano
- **backgrounds** = origini
- **rattled** = inquietare
- **beleaguered** = vessato, indebolito